

WENJING XIAO

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Pension systems and financial security in later life; gender inequalities in pension entitlements; family support, living arrangements, and older adults' health.

EDUCATION

East China Normal University **Shanghai, China**
Ph.D. Student in Social Security, School of Public Administration **Sep. 2025 – Present**

- School of Public Administration | Supervisor: Jinfei Lu

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law **Wuhan, China**
M.A. in Management, Social Security **Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2025**

- Selected coursework: Social Security Theory, Pension Insurance and Elderly Care Services, Medical Insurance, Social Research Methods, Intermediate Econometrics.

Jiangxi Normal University **Nanchang, China**
Bachelor's degree in Economics **Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2022**

- Selected coursework: Econometrics, Statistics, Public Finance, Development Economics.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-reviewed Publications

- Yang, H., **Xiao, W.**, & Fang, G. (2024). Long-term care arrangements and mortality risk among disabled older adults. *Chinese Journal of Population Science*, 38(3), 114–128. [In Chinese, CSSCI]
- Yang, H., Wang, J., & **Xiao, W.** (2023). The impact of childbearing on marital satisfaction. *China Youth Study*, 2023(5), 82–93, 96. [In Chinese, CSSCI]
- Yang, H., Wang, J., **Xiao, W.**, & Liu, Y. (2023). The impact of Internet use on marital satisfaction. *Population Journal*, 45(1), 96–112. [In Chinese, CSSCI]

Manuscripts Submitted for Publication

- **Xiao, W.**, & Lu, J. Living arrangements and mortality risk among older adults.
- Lu, J., & **Xiao, W.** Widowhood shock, support system weakening, and mortality risk among older adults.

CURRENT RESEARCH

Pension Credits for Childbearing and Caregiving and Women's Fertility Intentions

Randomized vignette experiment

- Collecting questionnaire data to examine whether pension credits for childbearing and caregiving influence women's fertility intentions.
- Investigating perceived compensation fairness and expected retirement income adequacy as potential mechanisms, with broader interest in gender inequalities in pension entitlements.

SELECTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Pension Guide Reports and Retirement Planning

Member, China Inclusive Ageing Finance Research Center (CIAFC)

Sep. 2025 – Sep. 2026

- Contributed to pension guide reports by interpreting China's three-pillar pension framework and calculating benefits and replacement rates under different contribution amounts and durations.
- Compared benefit levels across contribution tiers in the basic pension insurance scheme for urban and rural residents, linking contribution rules to retirement income adequacy.
- Assessed supplementary retirement planning needs by pension coverage, target replacement rates, and years to retirement, considering annuity insurance, retirement savings, wealth management products, and pension funds.

Widowhood Shock, Support System Weakening, and Mortality Risk among Older Adults

Co-author | Manuscript submitted for publication

Jun. 2025 – May. 2026

- Examined widowhood and mortality using four CLHLS waves (2008–2018) and time-varying Cox proportional hazards models.
- Investigated physical health deterioration, negative emotions, and weakened medical service support through causal mediation analysis for survival data and bootstrap inference.
- Examined differences by age, pension insurance coverage, and social interaction frequency to understand vulnerability following the loss of spousal support.

National Social Science Fund Later-stage Project: Fertility and Welfare of Older Adults Research

Assistant

2021 – 2022

- Assisted in literature collection and evidence synthesis on fertility behavior, population ageing, and older adults' welfare.
- Used CLHLS data to examine the relationship between fertility behavior and older adults' health outcomes, including self-rated health and chronic disease risk.
- Applied OLS and logit models to conduct empirical analyses and summarize key findings.
- Contributed to policy implication development and project report writing.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Outstanding Graduate Student, Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, 2022–2023.
- First-Class Academic Scholarship, Zhongnan University of Economics and Law, 2022–2023; 2023–2024.
- National Grand Prize, “Challenge Cup” National Undergraduate Academic and Technological Works Competition, Red Special Project, 2021.
- Provincial First Prize, Huachuang Cup Survey and Analysis Competition, Jiangxi Province.
- First-Class Academic Scholarship, Jiangxi Normal University, 2019–2020; 2020–2021.
- Second-Class Academic Scholarship, Jiangxi Normal University, 2018–2019.

RESEARCH SKILLS

- Methods: Longitudinal survey analysis, survival analysis, regression modeling, and mediation analysis; pension benefit and replacement-rate calculations.
- Data and software: CLHLS and CFPS; data cleaning and variable construction; Stata.
- Languages: English IELTS Overall 6.0 (Nov.2024) , CET-6.